

Minecraft beats your Adoption

10+1 Lessons You Should Copy





Sandra Kiel

Run a Gaming Agency

Kids and Dog

MVP M365

Do a lot Mentoring Stuff

(Wind-)Surf & Sail

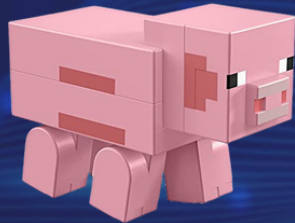
Play Minecraft





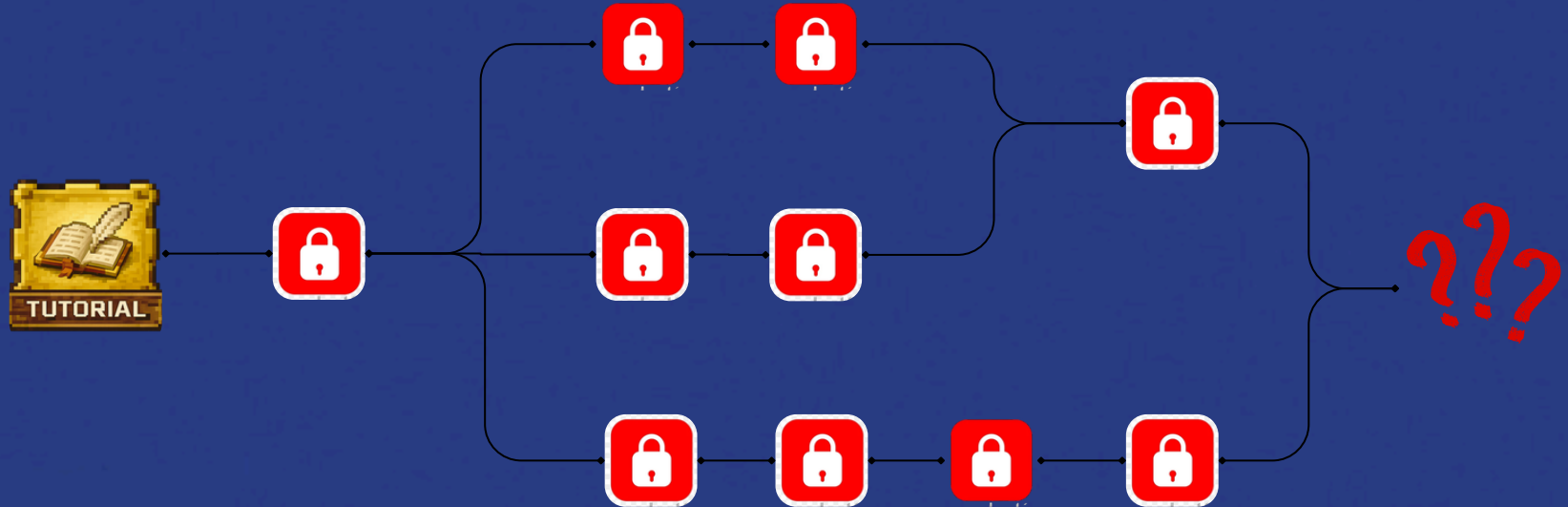
This excitement is our goal!

Today we make a Achievement run and design 10 Adoption power-ups that create this kind of pull.



We play this in game mode “hard”

Our Achievement Run





We've All Been Here...

The Launch Playbook

- Big announcement email ✓
- Training sessions booked ✓
- Champion network activated ✓
- Comms campaign sent ✓



We've All Been Here...

Because the system never becomes easier the second time.

The Launch Playbook

- Big announcement email ✓
- Training sessions booked ✓
- Champion network activated ✓
- Comms campaign sent ✓

Three Weeks Later...

Usage drops. Dashboards plateau. Champions go quiet. The Teams channel has tumbleweeds.

That's rarely a people problem. It's a design problem.

We built a launch. We didn't build a loop. And without a loop, nothing sticks.

The **Adoption** Core Loop

If your rollout doesn't create this loop, it won't stick.

Need: Create
Relevance

Action: Tiny
First Step



Upgrade &
Share

Feedback:
Show Value

Why Minecraft Is the Blueprint



Today, we copy some of that pattern for **Copilot adoption**.

Minecraft **Isn't** "a Kids' Game"



350M+

Copies Sold

The best-selling video game of all time.
Guinness World Record holder.



2014

Microsoft Acquired Mojang

For \$2.5 billion — one of the largest
gaming acquisitions in history.

10+

Years of Engagement

A decade-long proof of engagement
design. Players keep coming back.



Minecraft isn't popular because it's fun.

It's popular because it was *designed* to create mastery,
community and compounding reward.

That's the system we're borrowing today.



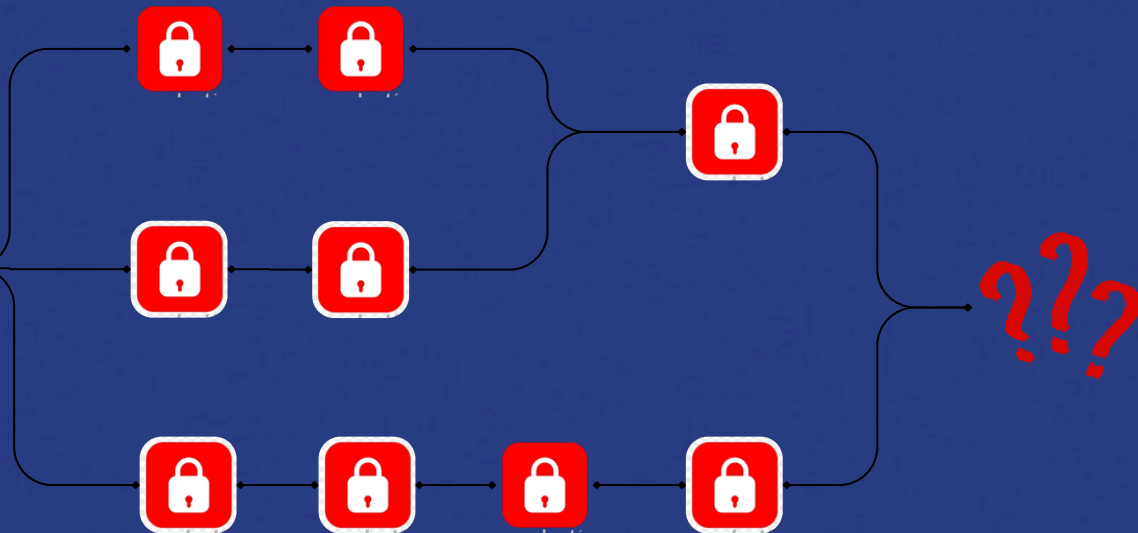
How do we design adoption
people **want to master**,
because it feels worth it?

Level 1

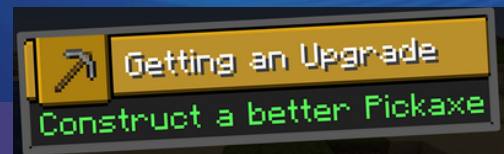
Unlocked!



Getting an
Upgrade



#1 Getting an Upgrade



 **Minecraft Moment:** You have Stone, you craft a Stone Pickaxe, now you are able to get stronger Tools and Weapons. Suddenly the night feels survivable.



Getting an Upgrade



Minecraft Moment

You have Stone, you craft a Stone Pickaxe, now you are able to get stronger Tools and Weapons. Suddenly the night feels survivable.

What Goes Wrong

We teach Copilot before people feel a win.
First experience = blank page + uncertainty.

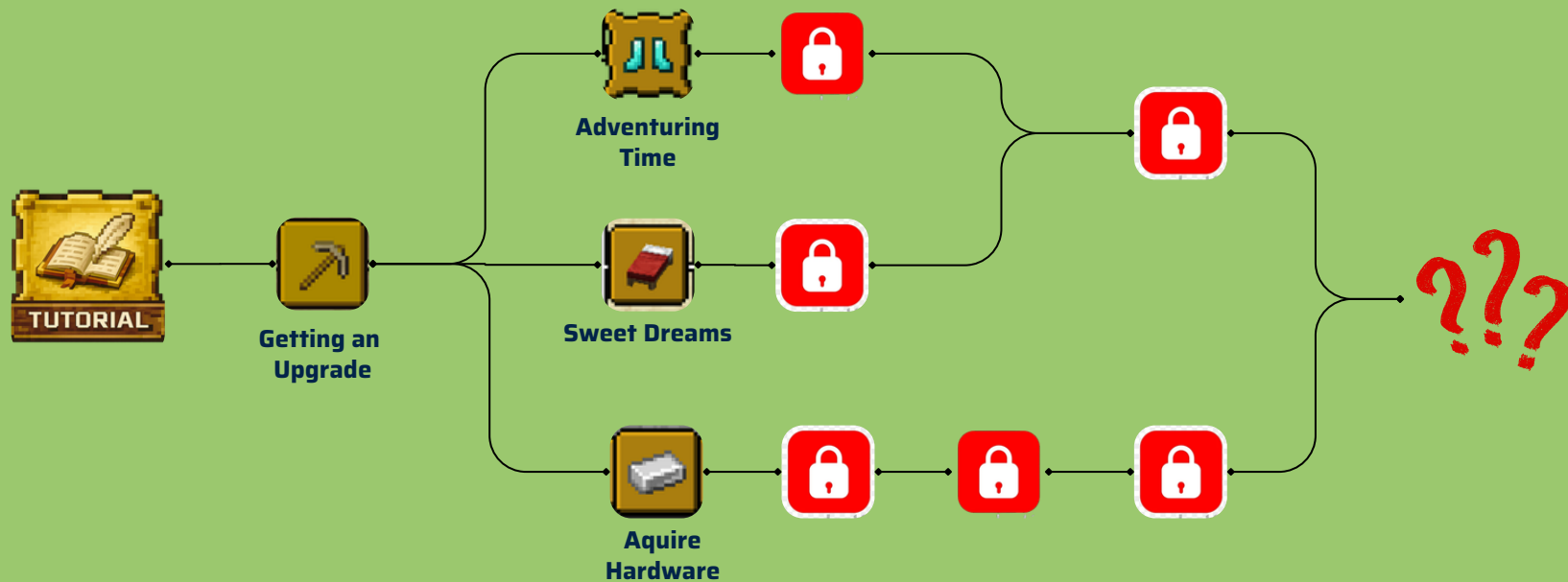
Copilot Fix

Give your users a first win in under 5 minutes by using a prefilled prompt and example output, then save it as a reusable snippet.

Artifact: First Quest Card (1 prompt + 1 example output + where to save it)

Level 2

Level 2



Adventuring Time



Minecraft Moment

You choose your own goal.

The Build Together

Mega projects in Survival mode.

The Achievement Run

Completionist mastery — yes, even the Nether.

The Speedrun

Same run, better strategy, personal best.

Your choice is the hook.

What Goes Wrong

We force one 'official' use case. Users don't feel it helps their day, so they ignore it.

Copilot Fix

Offer a Quest Menu:
Writing / Meetings / Research.
Users choose one starting quest.

Artifact: Quest Menu card
(3 quests + 3 starter prompts per role).

Sweet Dreams



Minecraft Moment

Now you have a bed. You can decide to sleep and skip the night. Or you try the cave. The bed is always there. Save you and your Spawn point.

What Goes Wrong

People don't try Copilot because they fear:

- wrong facts
- weird tone
- "I look stupid"

Copilot Fix

Teach People that Copilot is your first draft buddy but you are the editor.

"Draft first" removes that fear because:

- nobody expects the first draft to be perfect
- it gives permission to experiment

Artifact: "Copilot Safety Pass": Copilot outputs start as DRAFT. Humans publish.

Aquire Hardware



Minecraft Moment

Find iron means: Mine → smelt → upgrade tools, trade or use it → repeat. The loop IS the game. Nobody needs to explain it twice.

What Goes Wrong

Copilot is treated like a feature test. No habit forms because nothing gets reused.

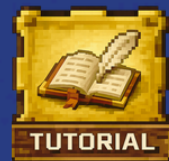
Copilot Fix

Make reuse the default: every output ends with Save → Tag → Share (1 click path).

Artifact: Prompt Template + Reuse Rule
(Context/Tone/Format + where it gets stored + tag convention)

Level 3

Unlocked!



TUTORIAL



Getting an
Upgrade



Adventuring
Time



Sweet Dreams



Aquire
Hardware



???



A Balanced Diet

This is the pufferfish slide: you do it even when it hurts because mastery demands it.



Minecraft Moment

You're not hungry. But: you're eating poison pufferfish because the run demands it. You take the risk. Because it's worth. It's voluntary discomfort for mastery.

What Goes Wrong

Copilot adoption teaches only the happy path.

Then real life happens: messy context, unclear asks, sensitive tone — and people stop using it.

Copilot Fix

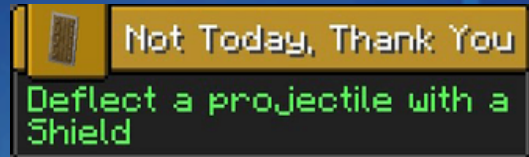
Run a Copilot Tasting Menu + Messy Practice:

- 10 small use cases to explore (breadth)
- 5 “awkward” scenarios to build confidence (messy reality)
- Always with: Draft → Critic Check → Fix

Artifact: Copilot Tasting Menu Pack



#6 Not Today, Thank You



Minecraft Moment

Having a shield is progress you can feel. Now you can beat any hostile mob attack. The sound and animation is visceral feedback that your preparation worked.

What Goes Wrong

We track usage dashboards. Dashboards measure activity. People need proof.

Copilot Fix

Create an Output Wall with 3 categories: Email / Meetings / Docs. Require 1 'before → after' each week.

Artifact: Output Wall Template (3 columns + 'before/after' slot + link to the prompt)



#7 Husbandry “Tab”



Minecraft Moment

You come back every day because it's a rhythm, not a reminder. The farm needs tending. The animals need feeding. It's a ritual.

What Goes Wrong

Adoption dies when the training ends.

Copilot Fix

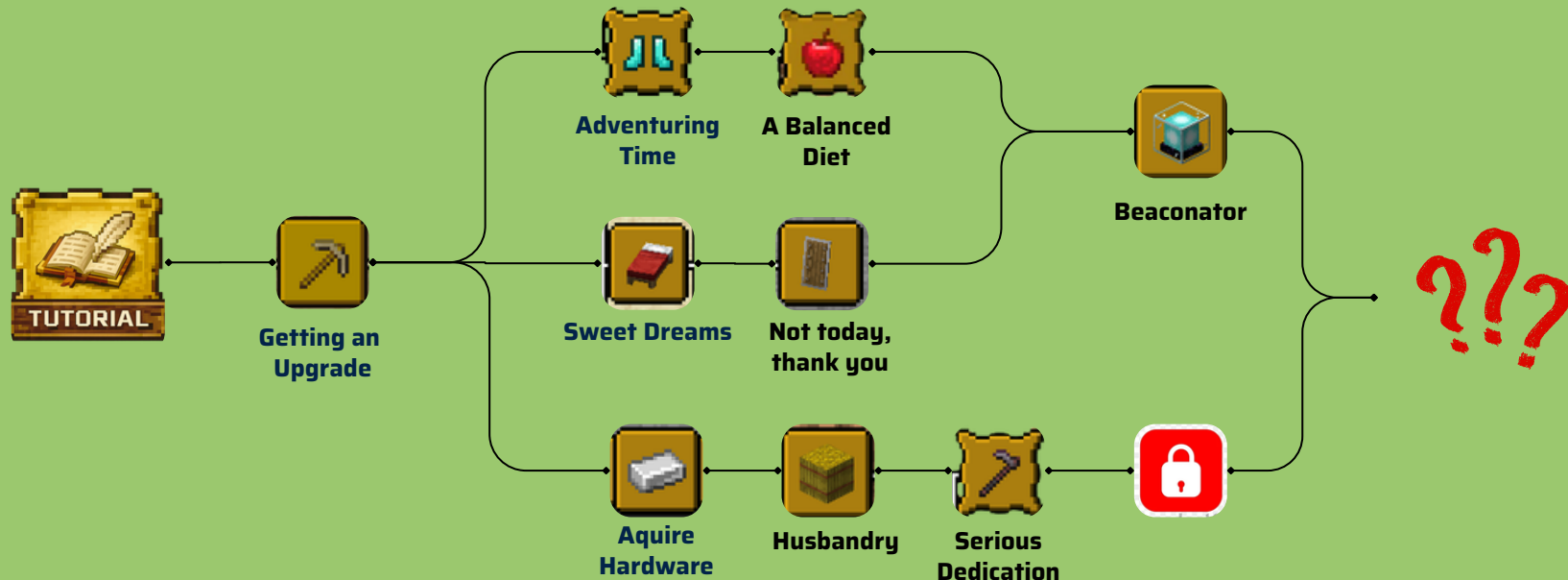
Install 3 micro-rituals:

- Prompt of the Week (2 min)
- Show & Tell (5 min)
- Build Night (30 min monthly)

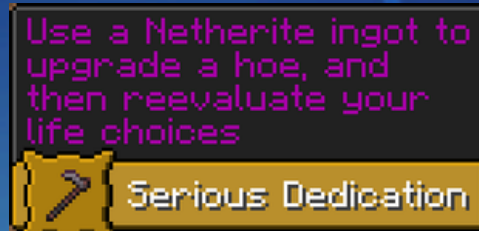
Artifact: Ritual Calendar + Changelog Template (one slide, one page)

Level 4

Unlocked!



#8 Serious Dedication!



Minecraft Moment

You upgrade a hoe to Netherite.

Not because you need it.
Because you want to prove you did the grind.

What Goes Wrong

People use Copilot once or twice, but never refine the result.
So nothing becomes really good.

Copilot Fix

Pick one recurring Copilot task and improve it until it becomes team-standard quality.

Artifact: A Gold Prompt Standard with example output and simple quality checks.

#9 Beaconator



Minecraft Moment

The grind together becomes a visible "WE DID IT." The beacon beam is visible from anywhere on the map. Everyone knows now. You beat the Wither!

What Goes Wrong

Project team is the bottleneck. Users are passengers, not builders.

Copilot Fix

Turn users into builders with a gallery that has rules:

- every entry = prompt + example output + 'when to use' + tag
- review weekly (5 minutes)

Artifact: Prompt Gallery Spec (fields + tags + review ritual)

Level 5

Unlocked!



TUTORIAL



Getting an Upgrade



Adventuring Time



A Balanced Diet



Sweet Dreams



Not today, thank you



Aquire Hardware



Husbandry



Serious Dedication



Ice Bucket Challenge

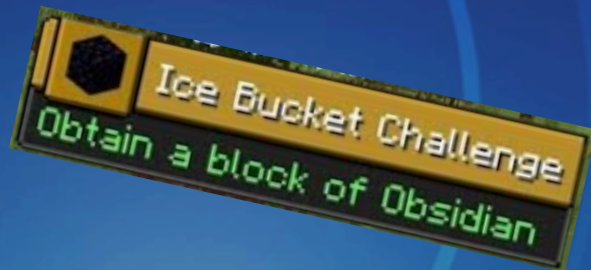


Beaconator

???



#10 Ice Bucket Challenge



Minecraft Moment

Obsidian unlocks the new dimension “nether”. Less grind, more power and prerequisite for all others. The reward here is capability expansion, not only a sticker.

What Goes Wrong

Rewards are symbolic: a certificate, a leaderboard mention, while the actual work stays just as hard.

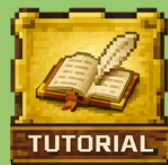
Copilot Fix

Reward = real relief. Give people tools that genuinely remove friction from their day. Add “reward is a shortcut that removes friction tomorrow morning.

Artifact: Copilot Shortcut Pack (Top 10 recurring tasks) (make it feel less generic).

Level 6

Unlocked!



TUTORIAL



Getting an Upgrade



Adventuring Time



A Balanced Diet



Sweet Dreams



Not today, thank you



Aquire Hardware



Husbandry



Serious Dedication



Ice Bucket Challenge



Beaconator



HOW DID WE GET HERE





The Boss Achievement

you have to get all status effects at the same time.



Minecraft Moment

This is the master achievement because it requires an entire system to work together... players want it... no reminders.

Why it's mastery

Not one trick — system control
Multiple mechanics stacked at the same time
Proof you understand the whole game

Why it's hidden

Too early = discouraging
Appears only when you've built enough foundations
It's the proof, not the start

Why it's hard

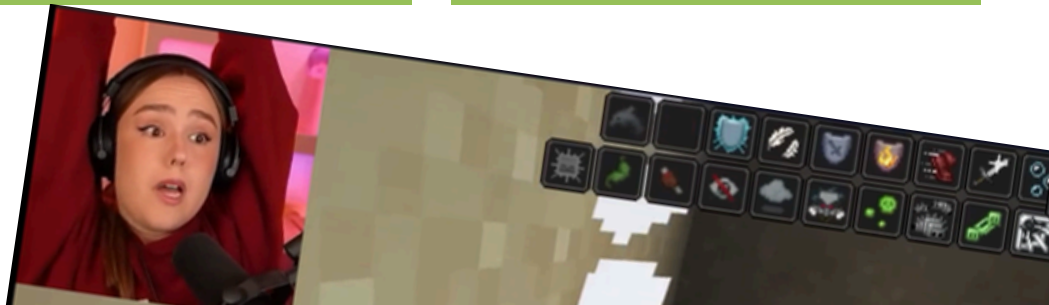
Preparation grind
Timing (seconds vs minutes)
Risk + recovery (one mistake resets)



Mastery needs an entire system, not one trick.



That's what adoption is.



How Did We Get Here?

What Goes Wrong

Most Copilot rollouts level up one thing (training, comms, champions, prompts).

But adoption needs the full stack, otherwise it collapses after go-live.

Copilot Fix

Build Copilot Adoption like a good game:

- Start easy (one small win)
- Make it safe (you can't get in trouble)
- Save your best moves (so it's easier next time)
- Do it together (share once a week)

When all four are there at the same time, adoption sticks.

Artifact (Boss)

A Copilot Adoption Runbook — built as a Power App
Questboard + unlocks + templates + progress tracking.
Not as PDF. As a system.



Try This for 30 Minutes

Before you redesign your entire adoption programme, run this experiment. It takes half an hour and will tell you everything about whether your loop is working.

The Experiment

1. Start a new Minecraft **Survival** world
2. Get **Getting an Upgrade** — your first stone tools
3. Notice what just happened to you

Ask Yourself

- What was my **Need**?
- What was the smallest possible **Action**?
- What **artefact** proved my progress?
- Did I want to **keep going**?
- If you felt the **pull**... your adoption system should create the same pull.

If your adoption programme doesn't feel like this... it's not the people. Stop pushing. Start building pull.

Takeaways

You learned why adoption drops after go-live.
Most teams build a launch. Thinking like Minecraft builds a loop.

You got a set of 10 (+1) Copilot “power-ups”.
A practical menu you can pick from (relevance, safety, habit, scale).

You leave with a 30-minute challenge.
Try one first win, create one artifact, and see if it creates pull.



**“Make it safe to try, or people
will play ‘Workaround Edition’.”**

Next: Key Notes



Paula Januszkiewicz

CQure Poland



Sonja Cuff

Microsoft Australia





Please evaluate this session in the App.

THANK YOU

Are there any questions?



Please scan the QR code to check in this session